💬 CHEAT SHEET

# 50 Prompts That Actually Work

Copy-paste prompts for everyday tasks

*Congratulations on completing Module 2. You earned this.*

## 1 Writing & Communication

Emails, messages, and professional writing — done right.

**Decline a meeting politely**
"Write a polite email declining a meeting request. I already have a conflict at that time but want to stay on good terms. Keep it short and professional."

**Write a complaint letter**
"Write a firm but professional complaint letter to a company about a product I received that was damaged. I want a refund or replacement. My order number is [ORDER NUMBER]."

**Follow up on a job application**
"Write a brief follow-up email for a job application I submitted two weeks ago. I want to express continued interest without coming across as pushy. The position is [JOB TITLE] at [COMPANY NAME]."

**Thank-you note after an interview**
"Write a sincere thank-you note to send after a job interview. I interviewed for a [JOB TITLE] role and want to reference that we talked about [TOPIC]. Keep it under 150 words."

**Ask a neighbor about noise**
"Help me write a message to my neighbor asking them to keep the noise down at night. I want to be friendly and not start a conflict. Just a few sentences."

**Birthday message for a coworker**
"Write a warm but professional birthday message for a coworker I don't know very well. Keep it genuine and brief."

**Apologize professionally by email**
"Help me write an email apologizing to a client for missing a deadline. I want to acknowledge the mistake, explain briefly without making excuses, and reassure them it won't happen again."

**Ask for a reference**
"Write an email asking a former manager to be a professional reference for me. I want to remind them of my work and make it easy for them to say yes. Keep it short and respectful."

**Respond to a negative review**
"Write a professional response to a negative online review for my small business. The customer complained about [ISSUE]. I want to acknowledge their experience and invite them to contact me directly."

**Cover letter opening paragraph**
"Write an engaging opening paragraph for a cover letter for a [JOB TITLE] position at [COMPANY NAME]. I have [X] years of experience in [FIELD]. Make it sound confident without being arrogant."

## 2 Research & Learning

Use AI as your personal explainer — for anything you don't fully understand.

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| **Explain something in plain English** | "Explain [TOPIC] like I'm a complete beginner with no technical background. Use simple words and an everyday analogy to make it click." |
| **Compare two options** | "I'm trying to decide between [OPTION A] and [OPTION B]. Give me a straightforward comparison of the pros and cons of each. My main priorities are [PRIORITY 1] and [PRIORITY 2]." |
| **Summarize a long article** | "Here is an article I want you to summarize. Give me the 5 most important points in plain language: [PASTE ARTICLE TEXT]" |
| **Help understand a medical term** | "My doctor mentioned [TERM/DIAGNOSIS]. Can you explain what this means in everyday language? I'm not a medical professional — just help me understand the basics." |
| **Research a company before an interview** | "I have a job interview at [COMPANY NAME]. What are the most important things I should know about this company going in? What questions might they ask me?" |
| **Break down a confusing document** | "I'm going to paste a document that is confusing me. Please read it and explain what it's saying in simple, plain language: [PASTE DOCUMENT]" |
| **Explain a current event simply** | "Can you explain [CURRENT EVENT OR NEWS TOPIC] in simple terms? I've heard about it but don't fully understand what's going on or why it matters." |
| **Help my kid understand a school topic** | "My [AGE]-year-old is struggling to understand [SCHOOL TOPIC] for class. Can you explain it in a way that makes sense for their age, with a simple example?" |
| **See both sides of a debate** | "What are the strongest arguments on both sides of the debate about [TOPIC]? I want to understand the issue fairly before forming my own opinion." |

## 3 Planning & Organization

From road trips to budgets — AI handles the logistics so you don't have to.

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| **Plan a road trip** | "Help me plan a [NUMBER]-day road trip from [STARTING CITY] to [DESTINATION]. Suggest a daily route with stops, and flag any must-see spots along the way." |
| **Build a weekly meal plan** | "Create a 5-day meal plan for a family of [NUMBER]. We like [CUISINE PREFERENCES] and try to avoid [DIETARY RESTRICTIONS]. Include a shopping list at the end." |
| **Make a packing list** | "Create a packing list for a [NUMBER]-day trip to [DESTINATION] in [MONTH]. The trip will include [TYPE OF ACTIVITIES, e.g., hiking, beach, business meetings]." |
| **Build a simple budget** | "Help me build a simple monthly budget. My take-home income is [AMOUNT]. My main expenses are rent ([AMOUNT]), groceries, utilities, and transportation. Help me see where my money is going and where I might save." |
| **Create a morning routine** | "Help me design a realistic morning routine for someone who has to leave the house by [TIME]. I want to include exercise, a healthy breakfast, and some quiet time. I'm not a morning person." |
| **Plan a birthday party** | "Help me plan a birthday party for a [AGE]-year-old who loves [INTERESTS]. We have a budget of around $[AMOUNT] and expect about [NUMBER] guests. Give me a theme, activity, and food ideas." |
| **Write a to-do list from chaos** | "I'm overwhelmed with everything I need to do. Here's my brain dump: [LIST EVERYTHING ON YOUR MIND]. Help me organize this into a prioritized to-do list with a reasonable order to tackle it." |
| **Plan a home project** | "I want to [HOME PROJECT, e.g., paint my living room / organize my garage]. Break it down into a simple step-by-step plan I can actually follow on weekends." |

## 4 Creative & Fun

AI is surprisingly good at the fun stuff — gifts, toasts, date nights, and more.

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| **Generate gift ideas** | "Suggest 10 gift ideas for a [AGE]-year-old who is interested in [INTERESTS/HOBBIES]. Budget is around $[AMOUNT]. Mix practical and fun ideas." |
| **Start a conversation with someone new** | "Give me 5 interesting conversation starters I can use when meeting new people at a [TYPE OF EVENT, e.g., networking event, neighborhood cookout, wedding]. Nothing cheesy." |
| **Write a funny wedding toast** | "Help me write a short, funny wedding toast for my [RELATIONSHIP, e.g., best friend, brother]. I want to tell a quick story about [MEMORY], make the room laugh, and end on something heartfelt. Keep it under 2 minutes." |
| **Come up with a creative date night** | "Suggest 5 creative date night ideas for a couple who has been together for a while and wants to do something different. We're in [CITY/TYPE OF AREA] and our budget is around $[AMOUNT]." |
| **Write a short story with a kid** | "I want to write a short story with my [AGE]-year-old. Start us off with an exciting opening paragraph about a [ANIMAL OR CHARACTER] who discovers [SOMETHING MAGICAL OR SURPRISING]. Keep it age-appropriate and fun." |
| **Suggest a movie or book** | "Recommend 5 [movies/books] I might enjoy if I loved [TITLE YOU LIKED]. Explain in one sentence why each one is similar." |
| **Plan a themed dinner party** | "Help me plan a [THEME] dinner party for [NUMBER] people. Give me a menu, a simple decoration idea, and one activity or game that fits the theme." |
| **Create a fun quiz for game night** | "Create a 10-question trivia quiz for family game night. Include a mix of easy, medium, and hard questions about [TOPIC, e.g., 90s movies, nature, world capitals]. Include the answers at the end." |

## 5 Work & Professional

Prep for meetings, write bios, brainstorm, and handle work tasks faster.

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| **Prepare for a tough meeting** | "I have a meeting with [PERSON/TEAM] about [TOPIC]. Help me prepare by listing the key points I should be ready to discuss and the tough questions they might ask me." |
| **Outline a presentation** | "Create an outline for a 10-minute presentation about [TOPIC] for an audience of [AUDIENCE, e.g., my team, new clients, school board]. I want it to have a clear structure with an intro, 3 main points, and a strong close." |
| **Summarize a long email thread** | "I'm going to paste an email thread. Please summarize what has been discussed and what the current action items or open questions are: [PASTE EMAIL THREAD]" |
| **Brainstorm ideas for a project** | "I need to brainstorm ideas for [PROJECT/CHALLENGE]. The goal is [GOAL]. The audience is [AUDIENCE]. Give me 10 different ideas ranging from simple to ambitious." |
| **Write a professional bio** | "Write a short professional bio for me. I'm a [JOB TITLE] with [X] years of experience in [FIELD]. I've worked on [NOTABLE ACHIEVEMENTS]. Keep it to 3-4 sentences and write it in third person." |
| **Prepare questions for a vendor call** | "I have a call with a vendor selling [PRODUCT/SERVICE]. I want to evaluate whether it's worth the cost. Give me 8 sharp questions to ask them." |
| **Turn meeting notes into action items** | "I'm going to paste rough notes from a meeting. Please organize them into a clean summary with clear action items, who owns each one, and any decisions that were made: [PASTE NOTES]" |

## 6 Problem Solving

Stuck on a decision or a tricky situation? AI is a great thinking partner.

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| **Make a pros and cons list** | "Help me think through a decision I'm facing: [DESCRIBE THE DECISION]. List the pros and cons of each option, and flag anything I might not have considered." |
| **Troubleshoot a problem** | "I'm having a problem with [DESCRIBE ISSUE, e.g., my WiFi keeps dropping, my dishwasher isn't draining]. Walk me through the most common causes and how to check each one, starting with the simplest fixes." |
| **Prepare for a negotiation** | "I'm going to negotiate [SITUATION, e.g., my rent, a salary offer, a car price]. Give me a strategy: what to say, how to open, what to push back on, and how to walk away gracefully if needed." |
| **Handle a difficult conversation** | "I need to have a difficult conversation with [PERSON] about [ISSUE]. Help me figure out what to say. I want to stay calm, be clear, and not make it worse. Give me a script to start with." |
| **Questions to ask a doctor** | "I have a doctor's appointment about [HEALTH CONCERN]. Help me prepare a list of questions to ask so I understand my situation and options. I want to make the most of my time." |
| **Evaluate a contract or agreement** | "I'm going to paste a [TYPE OF DOCUMENT, e.g., lease agreement, service contract]. Can you summarize the key terms, flag anything that seems unusual, and highlight anything I should ask about before signing? [PASTE DOCUMENT]" |
| **Decide between two big life choices** | "I'm trying to decide between [CHOICE A] and [CHOICE B]. My priorities are [LIST YOUR PRIORITIES]. Help me think through this clearly — I don't need someone to decide for me, just help me see it more clearly." |

## 7 Health & Wellness

From workout plans to sleep tips — practical health help, no jargon required.

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| **Build a beginner workout plan** | "Create a beginner workout plan for someone who wants to [GOAL, e.g., lose weight, build strength, just move more]. I have [X] days per week available and [X] minutes per session. No gym membership — just [EQUIPMENT YOU HAVE, e.g., no equipment, dumbbells, resistance bands]." |
| **Find a calming breathing exercise** | "Teach me a simple breathing or relaxation exercise I can do in under 5 minutes when I'm feeling anxious or overwhelmed. Walk me through it step by step." |
| **Get tips for better sleep** | "I've been struggling to fall asleep and stay asleep. Give me a list of practical, evidence-based tips for improving my sleep. Nothing complicated — things I can actually start doing tonight." |
| **Create a healthy meal from what's in my fridge** | "I have these ingredients in my fridge and pantry: [LIST WHAT YOU HAVE]. Suggest 2-3 healthy meals I can make with what's here. Keep it simple — I'm not a great cook." |
| **Understand a nutrition label** | "I'm trying to eat healthier and I'm confused by nutrition labels. Can you explain what the most important numbers are, what to watch out for, and what's mostly marketing noise?" |

**Pro tip: specificity is everything.**

The more specific you are, the better the response. Add details like your situation, tone, audience, and desired length. Replace anything in [BRACKETS] with your real information before pasting. A vague prompt gets a vague answer — a detailed prompt gets something you can actually use.